

THE GROOMSMEN GAUNTLET

Racquetball Handbook & Projections

Mission: Lose spectacularly. Do it together. Make it unforgettable.

On the evening of the wedding, the Bridegroom will enter the racquetball court and face a succession of gentlemen who have agreed to a very specific assignment: lose in scripted, epic fashion.

The outcome of each match is predetermined. The manner of defeat is limited only by imagination, theatrical commitment, and the laws of physics.

This is not really a racquetball competition. It is ceremonial theater disguised as racquetball.

THE WINDOW

7:09 PM	PROJECTED ARRIVAL His Airness arrives. <i>Probably not. But this is a projections document.</i>
7:10 PM	GAUNTLET COMMENCES First Challenger enters.
7:10–7:50-ish	THE GAUNTLET Single-volley matches, bits, betrayals, questionable officiating, heroic sacrifices, etc.
~7:50 PM	AWARDS Swag, glory, and whatever else we acquire.
Afterward	OPEN COURT King's Court-style free play. At some point Annie Masarie is expected to come whine.

HOW TO EARN YOUR PLACE

I will initially select approximately **5–8 Challengers** who submit an excellent plan for how they intend to lose to me. Your proposal does not need to be elaborate. It simply needs to make me say: **“Oh, this is going to be hilarious.”**

Additional places may be available for the faithful, the flexible, the wishy-washy, the shoe-challenged, and anyone whose performance anxiety requires additional accommodations.

It is a wedding. **I will have loaner shoes.**

POSSIBLE METHODS OF DEFEAT

The Bridegroom Cheats: You notice me committing an obvious and outrageous violation. You allow it. Perhaps you even assist.

Wardrobe Malfunction: Something goes catastrophically wrong with your attire at precisely the right moment.

Racquet Launch: Your racquet unexpectedly leaves your possession.

Through-the-Legs: You possess every opportunity to return the ball. You choose the most spectacularly unnecessary option available.

The Salami Incident: You produce a salami sandwich. No further explanation is currently available.

The GOAT Recusal: You are objectively one of the greatest basketball players in human history. You therefore determine that racquetball is beneath your jurisdiction and gracefully recuse yourself.

Whatever You Can Imagine: The floor is yours.

YOUR PERSONAGE

Each Challenger may optionally submit a Bitmoji/avatar, photo, ridiculous nickname, walk-on song, costume concept, personal insignia, proposed finishing move, autographed memorabilia, props, or anything else that contributes to your legend.

If you have something signed that you think would make this more ridiculous, **send it**.

PRODUCTION

The event will be **recorded and/or livestreamed** — **TBD**. The technical side of the wedding production is being organized separately, with relevant information available through the **wedding website and GitHub**.

The point is not to create a polished professional sporting broadcast. The point is to create something that, if recorded properly, we will still be laughing about twenty years from now.

CLASSIFIED INTELLIGENCE

There may be unexpected participants, contributors, witnesses, or dignitaries. I am deliberately saying nothing more at this time.

Certain faithful members of the Brotherhood may eventually discover that the Groom has made some **extremely unreasonable invitations**.

THE PRIME DIRECTIVE

You are not being asked to be a traditional groomsman. You are being asked to help me create **one completely ridiculous, completely voluntary, completely unforgettable event** with a group of men who have mattered enormously to my life.

There will be no perfect performance. There will be no athletic requirement. There will be no shame in saying, "Alex, I have absolutely no idea how I'm going to pull this off."

There will simply be a court, a racquet, a Bridegroom who is probably cheating, and a bunch of brothers willing to play along.

Make me look good.

Or at least make me look entertaining.

— Alex